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US Army Orders More Switchblade Kamikaze Drones From AeroVironment



ROJOEF MANUEL FEBRUARY 27, 2026 1 MINUTE READ



📷 Soldier carrying a Switchblade loitering munition. Photo: AeroVironment



AeroVironment has received a \$186-million contract to provide its flagship [Switchblade 600](#) and [Switchblade 300](#) loitering munitions for the US Army.

The order was placed under a [2024 prime contract](#) valued at up to \$990 million to equip the service's infantry battalions and maneuver formations with lethal, man-portable drones for five years.

According to the company, the latest shipment serves as the army's first adoption of the next-generation 600 product line and the first Switchblade package containing an explosively formed penetrator, a self-forging warhead effective against armored capabilities.

"This delivery order reflects the Army's confidence in the next evolution of the Switchblade family and its relevance to modern, contested battlefields," [said Brian Young](#), senior vice president of loitering munitions at AeroVironment.

"Switchblade 600 Block 2 and Switchblade 300 Block 20 build on years of combat experience while delivering [meaningful upgrades](#) in autonomy, resilience, and lethality tailored to today's operational demands."

The Switchblade System

AeroVironment's Switchblade portfolio offers a lightweight, precision-guided munition that can be launched from ground, air, and sea.

The drone in its 600 variant measures 130 centimeters (51 inches) long, weighs 15 kilograms (33 pounds), and has a diameter of 150 millimeters (6 inches).

It has a top speed of 185 kilometers (115 miles) per hour and an endurance of more than 40 minutes.

The 300 model spans 50 centimeters (20 inches) in length, weighs 3 kilograms (7 pounds), and has a diameter of 76 millimeters (3 inches).

The platform can travel at 160 kilometers (99 miles) per hour and stay active for over 20 minutes.

Both are offered with high-resolution electro-optical/infrared cameras, training and field operations training, associated software, and electronic countermeasure solutions.

Alongside the US, the Switchblade family of loitering munitions is operated by [Lithuania](#), the UK, and Ukraine.



US Marine launches Switchblade 300 drone during training in September 2021 in California. Photo: Alexis Moradian/US Marine Corps

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